



UNIVERSITY OF
GEORGIA

Course Syllabus

ECON 2105 – Principles of Macroeconomics

Summer 2024

Instructor Information

Name: Michael Kotrous
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Office: Amos B352
Office Hours: MTRF 1:30 p.m. – 4:30 p.m.; W 2:00 p.m. – 4:30 p.m.
Appointments: You may schedule a Zoom appointment by email
Website: <https://www.michaelkotrous.com>

Class Meeting Times

Location: Ivester Hall, Room E101
Time: Monday–Friday, 9:30 a.m. – 12:00 p.m.

Attendance Policy

Attendance is not required, but I emphasize the importance of attending every class that you can attend. In the May Session, missing one class is equivalent to missing an entire week of a Fall or Spring semester course.

There are no “excused” absences for non-exam class days. In practice, this means that I will not award participation credit or excuse an additional homework assignment if you must miss class due to an illness or emergency. The grading policies are defined such that you may miss up to three classes for any reason and earn full credit for course participation. Further, your lowest homework score will be dropped when calculating your final course grade.

You are allowed to complete a make-up exam if you face a documented illness or emergency (or have a valid scheduling conflict) that prevents you from taking the exam during the allotted class time. See the section on grading for exams for more details.

If illness or an emergency may result in you missing more than three classes, please contact Student Care & Outreach using the information under UGA Well-Being Resources in this syllabus.

Course Description & Details

Economists study how individuals and businesses make choices among alternative uses of scarce resources. This course introduces students to how markets align the interests of individuals and businesses to efficiently allocate the economy's scarce resources. Students will learn about supply, demand, and market equilibrium, as well as how economists study the welfare implications of government policies that alter market outcomes.

With the core tools of economic analysis at hand, students turn their attention to the subdiscipline of macroeconomics. Macroeconomists analyze the aggregate economic performance of nations. As macroeconomists do, the course separates the study of long-run economic growth from analysis of the short-run fluctuations of the business cycle. To engage in macroeconomics, students learn how macroeconomists measure key economic indicators like gross domestic product (GDP), inflation, and unemployment. Further, students learn about the key macroeconomic institutions in the U.S. and how to separately evaluate monetary and fiscal policy actions by applying the economic model of aggregate supply and aggregate demand.

Topics

- Overview of Economics
- Supply and Demand
- Markets
- Measuring Production and the Standard of Living
- Employment and Unemployment
- Price Levels
- Economic Growth
- Investment, Saving, and Interest Rates
- The Monetary System
- Economic Fluctuations
- Monetary Policy
- Fiscal Policy
- Global Economics: Trade and Finance

Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

- Analyze opposing views on government intervention in the economy, as supported by different macroeconomic schools of thought.
- Identify and assess possible sources of bias in macroeconomic measures.
- Consider the pros and cons of using macroeconomic statistics like GDP or unemployment to characterize quality of life.
- Use supply and demand models to analyze cause-effect patterns graphically and numerically.
- Calculate key macroeconomic statistics using raw data.
- Apply relevant economic theories to predict the long- and short-run effects of changes to monetary and fiscal policy.
- Analyze whether the pursuit of self-interest can promote the social interest.
- Discuss the social and ethical considerations involved in the pursuit of efficiency versus equality.

- Characterize the ways in which today's economic choices can help or hurt future generations.

This course also fulfills the following university-wide institutional competencies:

- **Analytical Thinking:** The ability to reason, interpret, analyze, and solve problems from a wide array of authentic contexts.
- **Critical Thinking:** The ability to pursue and comprehensively evaluate information before accepting or establishing a conclusion, decision, or action.
- **Social Awareness & Responsibility:** The capacity to understand the interdependence of people, communities, and self in a global society.

General Education Core

This course fulfills the **CORE V: Social Sciences** requirement of the University of Georgia's General Education Core curriculum.

Course Details

Course #:	72321
Credit Hours:	3
Prerequisites:	None
Corequisites:	None
Equivalent Courses:	Not open to students with credit in ECON 2105E or ECON 2105H

Course Materials

Textbook

Title:	<i>Modern Principles: Macroeconomics</i>
Authors:	Tyler Cowen and Alex Tabarrok
Publisher:	Macmillan Learning
Edition:	Sixth
Format:	Achieve (digital)
ISBN:	9781319483203

Macmillan Achieve

An electronic version of the textbook is made available on the Achieve platform by Macmillan Learning. Students must register an account and enroll in the course on the Achieve platform. We will use Achieve to access the textbook, other supplemental materials, and complete graded homework assignments. All materials and assignments on the Achieve platform are linked on eLC.

When creating your Achieve account (or using an existing account), you **must** use your UGA MyID email (e.g., mk91537@uga.edu), not a pseudonymous email (e.g., michael.kotrous@uga.edu)

or personal email (e.g., Gmail). Failure to use the correct email address (or enroll in the correct course) will result in technical difficulties linking your grades in eLC and Achieve.

Purchasing Instructions

An Achieve license should be purchased as soon as possible. The first homework assignment is due on Thursday, May 16, and late homework submissions will not be accepted.

You should purchase an Achieve license directly from the publisher using the “Student Registration – Start Here” link in eLC. Detailed instructions are provided in eLC. You should **NOT** buy the textbook or Achieve license through the UGA bookstore. The bookstore only handles physical copies of the textbook, and purchasing from the bookstore will delay delivery of your access code.

Grading

Your final course grade is determined by the following components:

Component	Weight
Midterm Exam (May 22)	20%
Final Exam (June 5)	25%
Data Projects (2)	20% (10% each)
Homework (lowest score dropped)	25%
Participation (highest 11 of 14)	10%

Letter grades will be assigned according to the following minimum-grade thresholds:

A	A–	B+	B	B–	C+	C	C–	D	F
94	90	87	84	80	77	74	70	60	0

Final grades **will not be rounded**. Thus, a final grade of 93.99 will earn a letter grade of A–.

Exams

Two 90-minute, paper-based exams will be administered to assess your mastery of the application of economic theory and the empirical facts presented in this course. The midterm exam will be assessed during the normal class time on **Wednesday, May 22, 9:30 a.m.–11:00 a.m. in Ivester E101**. The final exam will also be during the normal class time on **Wednesday, June 5, 9:30 a.m.–11:00 a.m. in Ivester E101**.

If you have a known scheduling conflict with either exam date, please notify the instructor as soon as possible.

Make-up exams can be scheduled for those who face a sudden illness or emergency on the day of the exam or participate in a pre-scheduled, university-sanctioned event (e.g., varsity athletics).

Proper documentation of your illness, emergency, or scheduling conflict must be presented to the instructor before the make-up exam can be taken. If there are compelling privacy concerns for you to not disclose the cause of your absence to the instructor, you may coordinate with the office of Student Care and Outreach to provide such documentation.

Make-up exams will not be offered to students who miss an exam for reasons other than those stated above, and they will earn a zero on that exam.

Students with disabilities or who otherwise need accommodation to complete the exams must register with the Disability Resource Center (DRC) **prior to the exam**—accommodations cannot be applied retroactively, and I will not make accommodations for students who are not registered with the DRC. Accommodations may take several days to process, so I recommend contacting the DRC as soon as possible. See Accommodation for Disabilities in this syllabus for more information.

Data Projects

Economics is a social science, meaning that economic theory is tested scientifically using empirical observation and data. Further, an understanding of the macroeconomy requires learning key empirical facts that motivate economists, policymakers, and business leaders. Students will complete 2 data projects during the semester. Completing these projects requires only the use of Microsoft Word and Excel, or Google Docs and Sheets, all of which can be accessed for free via the University.

Tentatively, the due dates for each project are (1) Friday, May 24 and (2) Tuesday, June 4. Each data project will be posted to eLC one week prior to its due date. **Late submissions will not be accepted.** Detailed instructions related to these projects will be provided during the course.

Homework

Homework in this course consists of 7 online assignments on the Achieve platform. Homework assignments will assess your understanding of the material covered in lecture and offer immediate feedback on your preparedness for the midterm and final exams.

Homework assignments generally will be due at 11:59 p.m. on the class day **after** the in-class material is finished. For example, the in-class material for Gains from Trade is scheduled to be completed on Wednesday, May 15, so the corresponding homework will be due at 11:59 p.m. on Thursday, May 16. **Late submissions will not be accepted.**

You are welcome to work with your classmates on the homework assignments, and you may refer to the textbook or other course materials while you complete these assignments.

I will drop the lowest score of the 7 homework assignments for each student. Scores on the top 6 graded homework assignments will be equally weighted when calculating your final course grade.

Participation

A participation grade will be recorded each class day (other than the dates of the midterm and final exam) on the following scale:

- **3 pts.** Satisfactorily completed the participation assignment.
- **2 pts.** Attempted the participation assignment.
- **0 pts.** Did not attempt the participation assignment.

Participation assignments will be announced each day and generally consist of an in-class activity that involves practicing the concepts discussed in that day's lecture. Thus, whether you earn 3 points or 0 points for a given day's participation assignment will largely be determined by whether you attended that day's class.

The aggregate participation grade will be calculated by dividing the sum of your top 11 participation scores by 33. There are 14 class meetings at which participation will be recorded, meaning the lowest 3 will be dropped when calculating your participation grade.

Tentative Course Schedule

Unit 1: Fundamentals of Microeconomics (May 14–17)

- Gains from Trade
- Supply and Demand
- Market Equilibrium and Welfare

Unit 2: Economic Growth (May 17–21)

- Gross Domestic Product: Definition and Measurement
- Economic Growth: Catching Up vs. Cutting Edge
- Saving, Investment, and the Financial System

Midterm Exam: Wednesday, May 22, 9:30 a.m.–11:00 a.m. in Ivester E101

Unit 3: The Business Cycle (May 23–30)

- Unemployment and Labor Force Participation
- Inflation and the Quantity Theory of Money
- Aggregate Demand and Supply

Class Cancelled: Monday, May 27 (Memorial Day)

Unit 4: U.S. Macroeconomic Institutions (May 31–June 4)

- The Federal Reserve and Monetary Policy
- The Federal Budget and Fiscal Policy

Final Exam: Wednesday, June 5, 9:30 a.m.–11:00 a.m. in Ivester E101

Course Statements & Policies

Academic Honesty & Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy

All students at the University of Georgia agree to abide by the University's student honor code:

I will be academically honest in all of my academic work and will not tolerate academic dishonesty of others.

The University's academic honesty policy [prohibits certain conduct](#) among students, notably **plagiarism** and **unauthorized assistance**.

- Plagiarism is the presentation of another's work as one's own without proper citation. Students who quote or paraphrase the output of large language models (LLMs) when completing assignments in this course are expected to cite that output as they would cite any print or online source. Importantly, the citation should include a publicly accessible link to the AI conversation thread from which the student quotes or paraphrases the AI tool. Two examples are given below:

ChatGPT. Response to "How to properly cite AI." OpenAI, May 24, 2026. <https://chatgpt.com/share/6a138f64-e90c-83ea-a17b-73c300ec8b8d>.

Bing Image Creator. Response to "Cityscape at sunset in cubist style." Microsoft, August 26, 2024. https://th.bing.com/th/id/OIG1.giyozqMtQv0gACrZ2C0_?pid=ImgGn.

For more information on how to cite AI in academic work, refer to "[How Do I Cite Generative AI?: Chicago \(18th ed.\)](#)" on the McMaster University Libraries website.

- Unauthorized assistance is the giving or receiving of help without prior approval from the course instructor. When working on any graded work that is *NOT* an exam, students may work with each other, use lecture notes and other materials on the course eLC page, or consult online resources, *including AI tools*. However, each student is expected to submit work that is their own for all graded assignments. During exams, giving or receiving assistance from other students or any other party (e.g., AI tools or Internet-connected devices like smart watches) is expressly prohibited.

The penalty for the first instance of prohibited conduct is a grade of zero on the affected assignment. A second instance of prohibited conduct results in a grade of F for the course. Please note that prohibited conduct under the University's academic honesty policy is not limited to only instances of plagiarism and unauthorized assistance.

AI Literacy Resources

I encourage students to develop their AI literacy skills during this course by using AI tools in ways that comply with the University's and this course's academic honesty policy. The University of Georgia provides students free access to several AI resources that meet its privacy and data security standards, including [Microsoft Copilot](#), [Google Gemini](#), and [Google's NotebookLM](#). Other

AI tools, like OpenAI's ChatGPT and Anthropic's Claude, offer free tiers of their services. See <https://aihub.uga.edu/resources-tools/students/> for more on AI resources available to UGA students.

Accommodation for Disabilities

If you plan to request accommodations for a disability, please register with the Accessibility & Testing office (formerly the Disability Resource Center). They can be reached by visiting Clark Howell Hall, calling 706-542-8719 (voice) or 706-542-8778 (TTY), or by visiting <https://accessibility.uga.edu/>.

UGA Well-Being Resources

UGA Well-being Resources promote student success by cultivating a culture that supports a more active, healthy, and engaged student community. Anyone needing assistance is encouraged to contact Student Care & Outreach (SCO) in the Division of Student Affairs at 706-542-8479 or visit <https://sco.uga.edu>. Student Care & Outreach helps students navigate difficult circumstances by connecting them with the most appropriate resources or services. They also administer the Embark@UGA program which supports students experiencing, or who have experienced, homelessness, foster care, or housing insecurity.

UGA provides both clinical and non-clinical options to support student well-being and mental health, any time, any place. Whether on campus, or studying from home or abroad, UGA Well-being Resources are here to help.

- Well-being Resources: <https://well-being.uga.edu>
- Student Care and Outreach: <https://sco.uga.edu>
- University Health Center: <https://healthcenter.uga.edu>
- Counseling and Psychiatric Services: <https://caps.uga.edu> or CAPS 24/7 crisis support at 706-542-2273
- Health Promotion / Fontaine Center: <https://healthpromotion.uga.edu>
- Accessibility & Testing: <https://accessibility.uga.edu>

Additional information, including free digital well-being resources, can be accessed through the UGA app or by visiting <https://well-being.uga.edu>.

Student Success Resources

The Office for Student Success and Achievement (OSSA) empowers students to achieve success throughout their academic journey. Through free peer tutoring, academic coaching, UNIV student success courses, Bulldog Basics, and first-generation student support, we promote well-being, student learning, and community building. To connect with OSSA, email ossa@uga.edu, call (706) 542-0163, or visit Milledge Hall (near Reed Hall and Sanford Stadium).

Disclaimer

The course syllabus is a general plan for the course; deviations announced to the class by the instructor may be necessary.